

SCOLIOSIS

Avoid anything that causes numbness; consider strengthening your back muscles by practicing Side Plank pose and gently stretching in the opposite direction of the curvature.

SHOULDER DISLOCATION, HISTORY OF

Avoid any extreme shoulder extension, especially while weight bearing, such as in Wheel pose; consider focusing your practice on strengthening.

SINUSITIS

Be careful of inversions and spinal extensions; you may find the alternate nostril breathing technique difficult.

SPINAL STENOSIS

Be careful of spinal extension.

SPONDYLOLISTHESIS

Ask your doctor what to avoid in your individual case. However, general guidance is: be careful of spinal extension and spinal rotation; avoid deep twisting, moderate or

deep backbends, and jumping into poses.

STROKE, HISTORY OR RISK OF

Be wary of inversions and extreme cervical extension; avoid anything that puts pressure on the neck.

VERTIGO/DIZZINESS

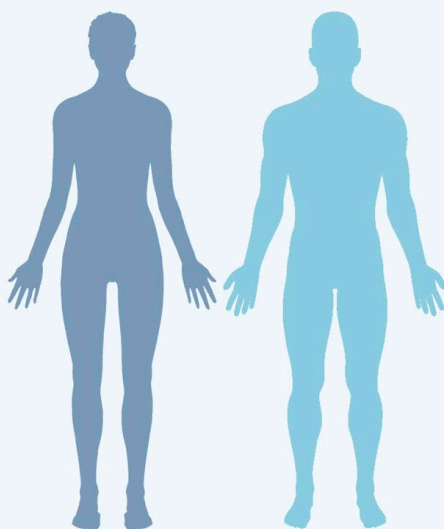
See Low Blood Pressure.

Approaching yoga with respect

The Yamas and Niyamas are the ethical guidelines for a yogic lifestyle. Traditionally, a guru would require that a practitioner lives these principles before learning any asana, to prevent ego and injury.

YAMAS (SELF-CONTROL)

- **Ahimsa (nonharm):** don't do anything that hurts or increases current pain
- **Satya (truthfulness):** be truthful with yourself about what your body can do today
- **Asteya (nonstealing/abundance):** focus on the things you can do instead of what you cannot do
- **Brahmacharya (moderation):** practice everything in moderation to regulate your energy
- **Aparigraha (nonpossession):** there is no need to grasp for a body you used to have, or to be jealous of the person practicing next to you.



NIYAMAS (SELF-REGULATION)

- **Saucha (cleanliness):** organize your props and practice area to prevent falls or distraction
- **Santosha (contentment):** find contentment with where you are physically and mentally today
- **Tapas (self-discipline):** balance your burning desire to improve with the practice of nonharm
- **Svadhyaya (self-study):** observe your breath and energy today and adjust your practice to respect that
- **Ishvara Pranidhana (surrendering/accepting):** allow a sense of surrendering to what is in the present moment, changing what you can (for example, using a prop for comfort in a pose), but accepting what you cannot change. Just be.